

In the next chapter we'll unpack some great habits for your individual Money Type/s and Money Stories. But first, let's begin with some basic financial habits that work for everyone. Finance 101, if you will. And yes, we're starting with the basics even after I've just binged on about developing habits and systems unique to you.

Why start here? If you remember from [Chapter 3](#), the research about basic financial literacy shows that across the globe we're either failing or flailing with even the simplest money concepts. So, I'm not going to presume that you have a great base of financial knowledge and habits to draw from. Instead, we're going to start with the simplest of financial habits that can apply to any Money Type or Money Story, which you know by now doesn't mean I'm talking about budgets; instead, I'm talking about goal-setting, bank accounts and automation.

Seth Godin, bestselling author and New York marketing guru, put it best when he said:

It's tempting to believe that left to our own devices, we'll all maximize our health, make smart investment decisions and generally follow our instincts on the road to happiness.

But it turns out that cigarettes are addictive, that financial distress causes people to make short-term decisions that are damaging, and that we even have trouble doing smart and easy things with a 401(k).

As we discovered from the research into self-control, most of us don't have the willpower to stop ourselves overspending. Or we tend to raise our spending to match our new salary every time we receive a pay rise. A few of us might even be hoarding our money and not spending at all because we're scared to touch our pot of savings—this might seem better than overspending, but it means we're not enjoying our lives in the moment, and during times of low interest rates and low wage growth this approach can be financially disastrous. That's where a basic financial system of goal-setting, bank accounts and automation can be helpful.

Remember at the start of this book when I described my compulsion for chocolate? If you pop a block of chocolate in front of me, I promise you I'll eat the lot. If you pop two chocolate squares down and hide the rest, you